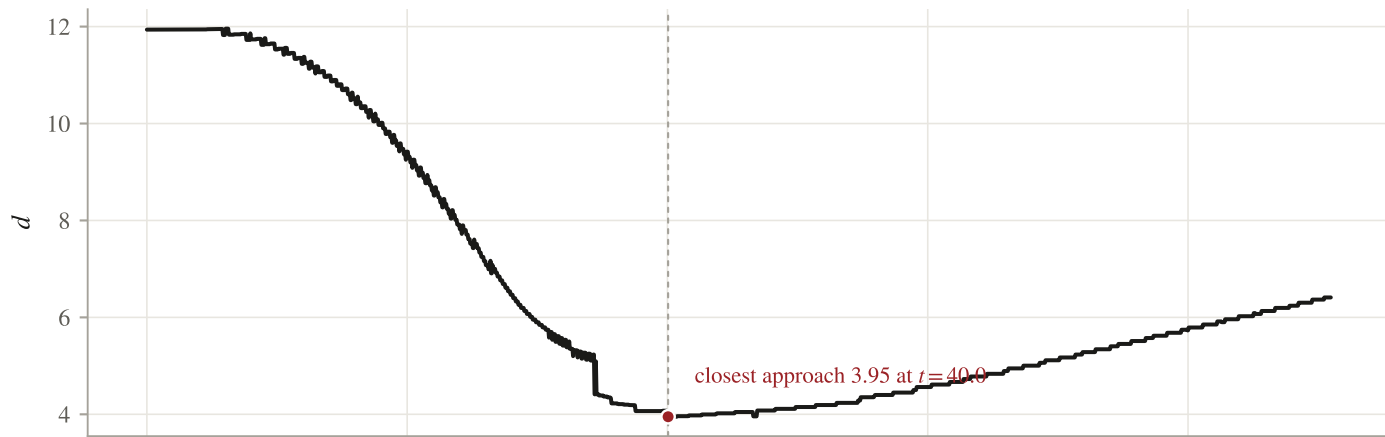


$p=0.45$: a fly-by, not a merger — the throat well relaxes, it does not collapse

(a) tracked separation of the two throats



(b) each throat's own monitor — the minimum χ in its half-space (gauge-dependent, not an areal radius)

